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System and method for extracting noxious chemicals from naturally-occurring raw materials and creating useful products

Abstract

A system may be configured to extract useful products from raw materials. Some systems include (1) a wet-grinding apparatus that includes (a) a conveyance for receiving and directing a slurry containing carrier liquids with suspended raw materials, (b) a high torque motor, (c) a motor drive operably coupled to be driven by the high torque motor (d) a set of flat grinding disks that include at least one rotor disk that is operably coupled to be driven by the motor drive, the set configured, when the at least one rotor disk is driven by the motor drive, to accept the slurry from the conveyance, to grind the suspended raw materials, and to discharge the slurry, and (2) a microwave with a microwave emitter configured to emit microwave radiation toward the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the slurry is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) The present application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/040,517, entitled “System and Method for Extracting Noxious Chemicals from Naturally-Occurring Raw Materials and Creating Useful Products,” filed Jun. 17, 2020.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) Certain embodiments pertain to a system and method for extracting noxious chemicals from naturally-occurring raw materials. Some particular embodiments pertain to a system and method for extracting noxious chemicals from naturally-occurring raw materials and converting the raw materials into useful products.

BACKGROUND

(2) Many naturally-occurring raw materials have noxious or toxic chemicals that must be extracted before these raw materials can be converted into useful products. Some of these raw materials may be plant stocks of some invasive, toxic, or poisonous plants. These plant stocks often contain noxious or toxic chemicals. For example, many invasive, toxic, or poisonous plants, such as tumbleweed (*salsula targus*), naturally contain oxalic and di-oxalic acids which are toxic to animals and humans. Other invasive or noxious plants include kudzu, rosemary bean (*Abrus precatorius*) and sage brush. There is a need for systems and methods to extract the noxious or toxic chemicals from plant stocks derived from the above plants and to convert the plant stocks into useful products.

(3) A similar issue arises in the context of petroleum and/or natural gas extraction from sands and similar materials such as shale, zeolite, and sandstone (collectively referred to as “sand”). There is also a need for systems and methods to extract the petroleum and/or natural gas from the sand.

SUMMARY

(4) The following summary introduces at a high level a limited number of topics described in the Detailed Description. This summary is not intended to identify key or essential features and should not be used for that purpose. In addition, this summary is not intended to be used as a guide to the scope of the claims. Instead, this Summary is provided as an introduction for the reader.

(5) Some embodiments may include a system that is configured to extract useful products from at least one of invasive, a poisonous or a toxic plant stock.

(6) In some embodiments, the system may include at least a wet-grinding apparatus. The wet-grinding apparatus may include at least (1) a fluid conveyance configured for receive and direct a slurry flow that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least suspended plant stock, (2) a high torque motor, (3) a motor drive operably coupled to be driven by the high torque motor, (4) a set of flat grinding disks that are operably coupled to be driven by the motor drive and that are configured, when receiving power via the motor drive, to accept the slurry flow, to grind the

suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry flow, and (5) a fluid outflow configured to receive the discharged ground slurry flow and to evacuate the ground slurry flow to outside the wet-grinding apparatus.

(7) Some embodiments further include at least a microwave unit that includes at least a microwave emitter configured to emit microwave radiation toward the slurry; and wherein the microwave unit is configured to direct microwave radiation toward the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the slurry is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus.

(8) Some additional embodiments provide a method for extracting useful products from at least one of invasive, poisonous or toxic plant stock. In some embodiments the method may include at least conveying a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some plant stock suspended in the one or more carrier liquids, the conveying being performed at least in part with a conveyance of a wet-grinding apparatus.

(9) In some embodiments the method further includes at least driving at least one disk of a set of flat grinding disks, of the wet-grinding apparatus, with a motor drive coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry on one or more surfaces, to grind the suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry;

(10) In some embodiments the method further includes at least receiving the discharged slurry flow and evacuating it outside the wet-grinding apparatus.

(11) In some embodiments the method further includes at least emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus . . .

(12) Some embodiments include a method for extracting useful products from petroleum-based reservoir materials. In some embodiments the method includes at least conveying a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some petroleum-based reservoir materials suspended in the one or more carrier liquids, the conveying being performed at least in part with a conveyance of a wet-grinding apparatus.

(13) In some embodiments the method further includes at least driving at least one disk of a set of flat grinding disks, of the wet-grinding apparatus, with a motor drive coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry on one or more surfaces, to grind the suspended petroleum-based reservoir materials, and to discharge the slurry.

(14) In some embodiments the method further includes at least receiving the discharged slurry flow and evacuating it outside the wet-grinding apparatus.

(15) In some embodiments the method further includes at least emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the suspended petroleum-based reservoir materials is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) Various embodiments will now be described, by way of example, with reference to the accompanying drawings. It should be noted that these drawings are not necessarily to scale. In addition, the drawings are simplified to avoid obscuring important principles with unnecessary details.

(2) FIGS. 1A thru 1F collectively illustrate a simplified exemplary process for extracting noxious chemicals from naturally-occurring raw materials and converting the raw materials into useful products according to some embodiments. Shown are at least various operations and exemplary equipment for performing the various operations.

(3) FIG. 2 is a simplified schematic diagram, consistent with some embodiments, of a wet-grinding apparatus with a rotary and a stator disc, an attached microwave magnetron unit and an encasement

for wet-grinding and microwaving slurry. Shown in simplified form are at least components of the wet-grinding apparatus, including an exemplary disk with grooves.

(4) FIG. 3 is a schematic diagram, consistent with some embodiments, of a standalone microwave for treating slurry with microwave radiation. Shown are at least a microwave magnetron unit, a microwave chamber, and a non-ferrous treatment coil.

(5) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram, consistent with some embodiments, of a wet-grinding apparatus with one rotary disk and two stator disks for wet-grinding a slurry.

(6) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram showing an exemplary process for extracting noxious chemicals from at least one of invasive, a poisonous or toxic plant stock and converting the plant stock and the extracted noxious chemicals into useful products according to some embodiments.

(7) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram, consistent with some embodiments, of a liquid concentrator or extractor. Shown are at least a bath with evacuation tubes for evacuating different liquids of different specific gravities.

(8) FIG. 7 is a process diagram, according to some embodiments, showing exemplary plant stock as it is processed according to some embodiments. Includes at least depiction of effects of wet-grinding and microwaving at a cellular level.

(9) FIG. 8 is a graph, consistent with some embodiments, illustrating a progression of cellular chemical release with internal cell pressure build-up due, at least partly, to internal microwave attack to cell's internal chemistry.

(10) FIG. 9 is a graph, consistent with some embodiments, comparing an effect on a rate of cell aerobic decomposition dependent on whether processing is (a) with a combination of microwave treatment and micro-grinding or (b) with conventional processing.

(11) FIG. 10 is a graph, consistent with some embodiments, comparing energy usage and reaction time dependent on whether processing is (a) with a combination of microwave treatment and micro-grinding or (b) with conventional processing.

(12) FIG. 11 is a graph, consistent with some embodiments, comparing time and energy to achieve total chemical release (of noxious chemicals) dependent on whether processing is (a) with a combination of microwave treatment and micro-grinding or (b) with conventional processing.

(13) FIG. 12 is a flow diagram illustrating a method according to some embodiments.

(14) FIG. 13 is a flow diagram illustrating the method of claim 12, with additional optional embodiments.

(15) FIG. 14 is a flow diagram illustrating the method of claim 12, with additional optional embodiments.

(16) FIG. 15 is a flow diagram illustrating the method of claim 12, with additional optional embodiments.

(17) FIG. 16 is a flow diagram illustrating the method of claim 12, with additional optional embodiments.

(18) FIG. 17 is a flow diagram illustrating a method according to some embodiments.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(19) Some embodiments are now described with reference to the above-described figures. In the following description, multiple references are often made to “some embodiments.” These references to “some embodiments” are not necessarily referring to the same embodiments, as numerous and varied embodiments are possible. No effort is made to describe all possible embodiments. Sufficient embodiments are described so that those skilled in the art will become appraised of the relevant principles. In addition, disclosed embodiments are not necessarily preferred or advantageous over other embodiments. Accordingly, the scope of the claims is not limited to the disclosed embodiments but instead is limited by the actual language of the claims.

(20) Additionally, in various embodiments those skilled in the art will recognize that various combinations of features are possible. Accordingly, all features described below and referenced in the drawings should be considered optional unless explicitly otherwise indicated. That is, no

features should be considered essential unless explicitly indicated.

(21) Invasive plants often have toxic elements that greatly affect their efficacy and in many circumstances may be a threat to our environment from water absorption, poisoning, and vegetation retardation. This application presents a very unique technology that has been developed to convert these plant species into viable commercial products. It is known that the inherent so-called noxious chemicals in these plants can not be fully synthesized. The major chemical component can be compounded into a product but with less effectiveness. All the many other smaller amounts of key chemicals contained in these plants are nearly impossible to be added to a commercial product and when so added the results are a reduced efficacy compared to a naturally produced very green product.

(22) An example of a noxious plant is tumbleweed. When tumbleweed is processed and separated into a liquid byproduct and a wet cellulose byproduct, a variety of useful products are possible. The liquid byproducts of this plant can be very positive in the mite infestation elimination, control and reduction of zebra snails, aphids, and spider mites. The extracted chemicals appear to have minimal to no effect on living organisms such as bees. The cellulose byproduct can be refined into feed pellets, gluten-free flour, and used in direct production of ethanol.

(23) These are just a limited sample of the numerous possible products that can be achieved from just tumbleweed using the principles described herein. A fuller listing of possible products from just tumble weed includes pesticides, insecticides, silage, fungicides, cleaners, solvents, feed pellets, oil forms, vector control products, bleaching agents, thermal fluids, and ethanol and alcohol spirits. Some products could be based on oxalic acid. For example of oxalic acid and its other derivatives can be mixed with sweeteners to attract vectors. Sweeteners could be derived from tumbleweed carbohydrates.

(24) Some embodiments involve initial processing of plant stocks to form a water slurry in which small particles of the plant stocks are suspended. The slurry with the suspended plant stocks is then processed by exposing the plant stocks to a particle reduction by passing the plant stocks suspended in the slurry between flat grinding disks plant stocks to micron and submicron particles in microseconds, thus exposing the whole fiber structure of the plant stocks to release their inherent chemicals instantaneously and at the same time fiber cell structure of the plant stock is greatly expanded by bombarding the particles with microwaves. The water serves as a useful carrier in which additional additives may be added, thus making the final product's a superior compounded product for various product applications. Ultrasonic wave bombardment can also be incorporated into a process to assist with separating the liquid fraction from the wet fiber.

(25) I. Process for Processing Raw Materials-FIGS. 1A-1F

(26) FIGS. 1A thru 1F collectively illustrate a simplified exemplary process **100** for extracting noxious chemicals from naturally-occurring raw materials and converting the raw materials into useful products according to some embodiments. Shown are at least various operations and exemplary equipment for performing the various operations. Those skilled in the art will recognize that many combinations of the operations illustrated in FIGS. 1A thru 1F are possible. Thus, while operations **1** through **71** are shown, depending upon the starting plant stock and the desired final products, in many embodiments not all of these operations are needed. The core operations are as indicated in the independent claims, that is the wet-grinding and one or more of the microwave operations discussed below. Otherwise, the operations described below are optional, non-essential, and may or may not be included in various embodiments. And it is noted also noted that plant stock from some plant species may be processed without microwave treatment consistent with the principles discussed herein.

(27) Indeed, all operations should be regarded as optional. Additionally, although an order or sequence of operations is illustrated, this is not intended to be binding. Again, in many embodiments, depending upon the starting plant stock at the not all of these operations are needed. And they may be performed in sequences other than those shown.

(28) As noted, FIGS. **1A** thru **1F** also illustrate exemplary equipment that may, in some embodiments, be used to carry out the various operations. The exemplary equipment illustrated are merely examples. Those skilled in the art will recognize that dependent upon a variety of factors, such as conditions in the field, the plant stock being started with, and the desired final product, it may be possible to substitute similar or different equipment for that shown for a particular operation.

(29) Additionally, some of the operations shown in FIGS. **1A** thru **1F** are applicable to processing plant stock and its derivatives, others are applicable to processing reservoir materials for natural gas and petroleum recovery, and other operations are applicable to both. For ease of discussion and to avoid confusion, this document will first discuss the operations applicable to processing plant stock. Operations applicable only to reservoir material processing will then be discussed.

(30) A. Processing of Plant Stocks

(31) Referencing FIG. **1A**, in some embodiments, in Operation **1** invasive, toxic, or poisonous plants such as one or more of hemp **101A**, sage **101B**, white horse nettle **101C**, or tumbleweed **101D**, or other vegetative plants may be grown or identified. In some embodiments, a single species like tumbleweed may be harvested.

(32) Operation **2** may include at least harvesting of one or more plant species. In some embodiments the harvesting is performed with a commercial field harvester **102**, including a tractor or trailer unit. In some embodiments a single species such as tumbleweed is harvested alone. In other embodiments multiple species may be harvested. Example tumbleweed plus one or more of hemp **101A**, sage **101B**, white horse nettle **101C**.

(33) Operation **3** may include primary reduction. This includes chopping the plant stock to a size of approximately 6 inches to yield reduced plant stock **103**.

(34) Operation **4** may include at least one of bailing or contacting the plant stock to produce bailed or compacted plant stock **104**.

(35) Operation **5** may include transporting the plant stock, for example in a transport container **105**.

(36) Operation **6** may include storing the plant stock either in a single run of one plant or multiple of more than one type of plant. Stored plant stock **106** may be stored open or closed depending on, for example, product deposition.

(37) Operation **7** may include secondary volume reduction. This may include at least one of shredding, grinding or other volume reduction with secondary reducing equipment **107** (e.g., a rotary shear, a compactor, or a hammer mill, or other reduction equipment). Secondary reducing equipment **107** may also be equipped or associated with ferrous recovery removal devices to prevent damage to writing units and overall contamination.

(38) Operation **8** may include at least using a separator **108** (e.g., disk screen) to remove oversized or stringy branches or lambs back to secondary volume reduction to optimize size reduction efficiency.

(39) Operation **9** may include at least magnet detection with magnetic detector **109** to remove any potential ferrous objects to prevent damage to process equipment downstream.

(40) Operation **10** may include at least using additional magnets **110** (e.g., cross belt magnet or magnetic head pulley) for ferrous removal of small or previously un-removed ferrous objects.

(41) Operation **11** may include at least tertiary reduction of secondarily reduced plant stock by tertiary reducing equipment **111** (e.g. granulator, a grinder, or knife mill) with pollution control. Tertiarily reduced plant stock is of a size and weight suitable for wet-grinding (operation **20**) below.

(42) Operation **12** may be performed concurrently with Operation **11** and they include capturing air-suspended particles with air cleaning system **112** (e.g. cyclone or baghouse). Since the tertiary reduction equipment will generally be incorporating an air sweep system using open rotor design, the air carrier passing through the tertiary reduction equipment (e.g., a grinder) should be captured and cleaned with a cyclone or baghouse or a combination of both. The capture particles are then recombined with the outflow tertiary reduction equipment **111**.

(43) Operation **13** may include at least transporting tertiarily reduced plant stock via conveyancing equipment **113** (e.g. piping) to mixing apparatus **115**.

(44) Operation **14** may include at least adding any additives to tertiarily reduced plant stock. Types of additives are dependent upon the plant stock being processed and the end product desired. Cyclonic centri-cleaner with magnet for removal of unwanted innards and metal from the process downstream may be used.

(45) Operation **15** includes at least mixing plant stock with water to form slurry with a mixing apparatus **115** (e.g., hydra-pulper or high agitation mixer). In some particular embodiments, Operation **15** includes at least mixing dry material with an appropriate water percentage. The appropriate water percentage varies dependent upon a species of plant stock being processed. In some embodiments, sufficient water is added to create a slurry that is between 0.5 and 10 percent by weight. In some embodiments, vapors that are emitted during this stage of the process will be captured and sent to vapor recovery unit (See operation **25** below).

(46) Operation **16** includes at least pumping the slurry with a high pressure head slurry pump **116**, ultimately to the wet grind or microwave operations described below.

(47) Operation **17** includes at least removing sand or dirt or similar contaminants from the slurry along with any nonferrous metals such as copper or aluminum. In some embodiments this is performed with centri-cleaner **117**.

(48) Operation **18** includes at least making adjustments for flow or process fluctuations in the slurry flow being pumped via operation **16** above. In some embodiments operation **18** is performed with a surge tank with agitation **118**.

(49) Operation **19** includes providing water for the wet grinding operation **21** described below. In some embodiments operation **19** is performed with water tank **119**. In some embodiments operation **19** is performed in parallel with operations **17** and **18** described above.

(50) Operation **20** is performed with microwave unit **120** and includes first stage microwave treatment of the slurry with coils inside a microwave chamber. The slurry is treated during a continuous flow of the slurry through the coils. In some embodiments, instead of coils, a ceramic constructed tray system may be used inside microwave depending upon the material being processed. This first stage microwave treatment heats and expands plant cells suspended in the slurry for efficient particle commutation in operation **21** below. Some embodiments do not include first stage microwave treatment but instead provide a microwave treatment during or after operation **21**. In other embodiments microwave treatment may occur in one or more of operations **20**, **21**, **22** below. Other embodiments, dependent upon plant species, may not use microwave treatment at all.

(51) Operation **21**, a wet-grinding operation, includes at least micro-grinding the plant stock suspended in the slurry while it is still in suspension. It is performed with wet-grinding apparatus **121** (see FIGS. **1C** and **2**). In some embodiments operation **21** also includes microwave treating the slurry during the wet grinding operation (see discussion of FIG. **2**). Wet grinding is performed with either a twin disk or a three disk arrangement, depending on the final product to be produced. A two disk arrangement is one stator stone (a stationary disc) and one rotor disc. A three disk arrangement includes two stator disks on either side of a rotor disc. In some embodiments, the disks are either made entirely of stone or made of a steel alloy with an attached stone grinding surface. In these embodiments, the disks are said to include stone grinding surfaces. The rotor disk is configured to be driven by a motor drive which may include a tube that also carries a flow of slurry for placement of the slurry onto the stone grinding surfaces. Very high shear occurs due to grinding distances between stone grinding surfaces. During operation, the stone grinding faces are only separated by a thin film of the carrier liquid (often water) of the slurry, thus exposing plant cells suspended in the slurry to the shear of the stone grinding faces. This ruptures plant cells while reducing the size of plant stock material in the slurry to less than 100 microns. It also causes release of invasive, toxic, and/or poisonous chemicals from the plant cells into the carrier liquid (e.g., water). Additives added

to the slurry may assist this wet grinding process.

(52) Operation **22** is performed with microwave unit **122** and includes a secondary microwave treatment of the slurry similar to operation **20**. Microwave unit **122** may be similar to microwave unit **120** except that it is positioned and configured to receive the slurry after operation **21**. In some embodiments operation **22** is performed instead of operation **20**. In other embodiments operation **22** is performed in addition to operation **20**. Either of these operations may be performed in addition or instead of microwave treatment during operation **21**. Microwave unit similar to either units **120** or **122** are discussed relative to FIG. **3**.

(53) Now described, relative to FIG. **1C**, are various operations (**23-28**) and devices/equipment (**123-128**) associated with recovery from collective operations **123** (i.e., one or more of operations **120-122**).

(54) Operation **23** includes at least collecting vapors off-gassed from one or more of operations **120-122** in one or more containment structures **123** for transporting to vapor recovery unit **125**. In some embodiments, one or more of microwave unit **120**, wet-grinding apparatus **121**, or microwave unit **122** is associated with one or more containment structures **123** configured for capturing off-gassed vapors.

(55) Operation **24** includes creating a negative air pressure in the one or more containment structures and sucking the off-gassed vapors from the one or more containment structures and toward vapor recovery unit **125** (e.g., via one or more of piping, tubing, etc.). Operation **24** is performed with fan **124**.

(56) Operation **25** includes at least condensing the off-gassed vapors. This operation is performed with vapor recovery unit **125** (e.g. a condenser).

(57) Operation **26** includes filtering any gases that escape from vapor recovery unit **125** with a HEPA filter **126** or other particle capture.

(58) Operation **27** the recovered liquid from the condensed vapor in storage **127** (e.g a storage container for liquids).

(59) Operation **28** is discussed below relative to petroleum products and processing reservoir materials.

(60) Operation **29** includes at least pumping the slurry (e.g., via pump **116**) to a holding tank **129** after the end of collective operation **23**.

(61) Operation **30** includes at least receiving process slurry from holding tank **129** and separating at into a liquid fraction and a wet fiber. This operation is performed with separator apparatus **130** (e.g. one or more of a decanter, a basket centrifuge, or an SS Buchner funnel system). Ultrasonics may be employed with an SS Buchner funnel system to facilitate separation into the liquid fraction and the wet fiber. The liquid fraction may include chemicals such as oxalic acid and/or other plant derived chemicals.

(62) The remainder of the operations to be described include either processing of the liquid fraction or processing of the wet fiber. Processing of the liquid fraction starts with operation **31** and processing of the wet fiber begins with operation **50**. The description below first describes the operations associated with processing the wet fraction, beginning with operation **31**. The description then returns to operation **50** and the describes processing of the wet fiber.

(63) 1. Liquid Fraction Processing

(64) Operation **31** includes at least subjecting the decanted liquid fraction with ultraviolet light (at least in ultraviolet chamber **131** with an ultraviolet emitter) on a continuous basis to kill germs or prevent growth of bacteria. In some embodiments the author of life is UV-C. In some embodiments the wavelength of the ultraviolet light is between 100 and 3000 nanometers.

(65) Operation **32** includes at least adjusting, via pH adjustment equipment **132** (e.g. an additive mixer) of the liquid fraction by adding or mixing acidic or caustic additives.

(66) Operation **33** includes at least with a heat exchanger **133** for optimal amylase exchange and effectiveness. Amylase being a high temperature enzyme that requires a optimal temperature range

for effectiveness. This operation and operation **34** below are not performed if amylase is not added-again dependent upon desired end products and beginning raw materials.

(67) Operation **34** includes at least adding amylase to the now heated liquid fraction with inline mixer **134**. This operation includes metering and dispersing amylase type products.

(68) Operation **35** includes at least analyzing sugars in liquid fraction for viscosity and/or specific gravity. This operation is performed with analyzing equipment **135**. Dependent upon the desired end product, the liquid fraction may be diverted to operation **42** (fermentation) described below.

(69) Operation **36** includes at least storing, in storage **136**, ultraviolet-treated liquid fraction-which may nor may not include amylase.

(70) Operation **37** includes at least concentrating the liquid fraction into concentrated densities and concentrated fractions with liquid concentrator **137**, which includes treatment with microwave radiation and ultrasonic waves. Liquids with concentrated densities and concentrated fractions may include concentrated liquids and high viscosity liquids in the form of a syrup or an oil emulsion.

The concentration of the liquid improves economic value and greater efficiency in further processing, for example in operation **41** below for processing into final products such as liquids, syrups, and/or oils. Vapors off gassed from this operation are transported to vapor recovery unit **25**.

(71) Operation **38** includes online mixing with online mixer **138** of additives into the liquid fraction.

(72) Operation **39** includes at least crystallizing the remaining liquid fraction at least in part with microwave crystallizer and granulator **139** to convert the remaining liquid fraction to crystals.

(73) Operation **40** includes packaging and/or final processing of crystals of operation **39** into final products within crystals facility **140**. These final products may be a combination of the extracted oxalic derivatives in a sugar form for direct use (e.g., as pesticides, or other pest control) or for resolubilization for spray applications. This is the final operation for these products.

(74) Operation **41** receives concentrated liquids and high viscosity liquids at facility **141** from operation **37** for final packaging as liquid, theory of spirit, and oils. This is the final operation for these products.

(75) Operation **42** includes at least receiving liquid with starches and sugars analyzing operation **35** and fermenting these liquids in fermentation tank **142**. In some embodiments fermentation tank **142** provides agitation as well as fermentation. This operation includes converting the liquid fraction (or a portion thereof) into alcohol via starch reduction of plant stock starches to a sugar. Vapors off gassed from operation **42** are transported to vapor recovery unit **25**.

(76) Operation **43** includes at least adding additives to fermentation tank **142** while liquid is fermenting in operation **42**.

(77) Operation **44** includes at least decanting and distilling the fermented liquid from operation **42** with distiller **144**. Off-gassed vapors are transported to vapor recovery unit **125**. This operation produces a distilled liquid which moves to operation **46**. This operation also produces bottoms which are a dry fraction.

(78) Operation **45** includes at least sending the dry fraction from operation **44** to solids stream as a solid waste product.

(79) Operation **46** includes at least receiving ethanol from operation **45**. For some of the ethanol is for an ethanol product and this is a final operation. For some other ethanol moves to operation **47**.

(80) Operation **47** includes at least producing specialized spirits such as whiskies, brandys, gin and vodka from some of the ethanol from operation **46**. This is a final operation for these products.

(81) Operation **48** includes at least separating yeasts and moldy fraction from fermentation tank **142** and moving towards operation **49**. These items may also be reused in operation **42** in further fermentation.

(82) Operation **49** includes at least receiving the yeasts and moldy fraction **149** as final products. This is a final operation for these products.

(83) 2. Wet Fiber Processing

- (84) Discussion now returns to the processing of the wet fiber produced in operation **30**. The discussion begins with operation **50**.
- (85) Operation **50** includes at least obtaining wet fiber as an output of operation **30** and transporting to operation **51**. Alternatively or additionally, Operation **50** includes at least transporting the wet fiber to operation **67** (transporting to silage production), discussed below.
- (86) Operation **51** includes at least washing the wet fiber in a wash system **151**. Water may be reused from one or more wash tanks of the wash system **151**.
- (87) Operation **52** is discussed later regarding petroleum products.
- (88) Operation **53** includes at least rinsing the web fiber in rinse system **153** (including at least rinse tanks, as depicted).
- (89) Operation **54** includes at least treating washed and rinsed fiber with UV-C radiation (e.g., with ultraviolet (UV-C) chamber **154** configured with ultraviolet emitter) to prevent bacterial growth from the wash and rinse.
- (90) Operation **55** includes at least drying the wet fiber with a drying system **155** (including at least one or more of fluid bed, tray drier, rotary drier, or flash dryers for removal of moisture. Off-gassed vapors from drying operation may be sent to vapor recovery unit **25**. Operations **56** and **57** are discussed below relative to petroleum products.
- (91) Operation **58** includes at least adding additives to the dry fiber. Some additives may be from previously processed plant stock.
- (92) Operation **59** includes at least mixing additives into dry fiber with mixer **159** (may also include compounding). These additives assist with dispersion of final products.
- (93) Operation **60** includes at least receiving output from operation **59** as gluten free powder. This is a final operation for this final product.
- (94) Operation **61** includes at least receiving output of operation **59** and pelletizing it (e.g., with pelletizing and processing unit **161**) as one or more of feed pellets or processing into one or more industrial powders. This product may incorporate silage from operation **68** discussed below regarding petroleum products. Incorporating the silage into these products is operation **70**.
- (95) Operations **62-66** are discussed below relative to petroleum products.
- (96) As discussed above, operation **67** includes at least transporting at least some of the wet fiber separated in operation **30** for silage production in operation **68**. For at least some of the wet fiber, Operation **67** is an alternative to operation **50**, as discussed above.
- (97) Operation **68** includes at least fermenting the wet fiber in an anerobic atmosphere in enclosed silage mixer **168** for conversion of starches to sugar. This conversion of starches to sugars significantly improves the taste and appeal of this as animal feed and reduction of storage time. Additional solid waste from this process may be added to the silage since obnoxious elements are removed at various operations.
- (98) Operation **69** includes at least slowly releasing one or more inert gases (e.g., from gas cannister **169**) to the bottom of enclosed silage mixer **168** via porous piping or tubing. This introduction of the one or more inert gases into the moist silage improves silage conversion in an anaerobic atmosphere.
- (99) Operation **70** includes at least transporting finished silage to pelletizing and processing unit **161** for incorporation into pellets and/or powders. This is a final operation for these products and the final operation for this process **100**.
- (100) B. Processing of Petroleum/Natural Gas Reservoir Materials for Petroleum Products
- (101) Preliminarily it is noted that reservoir materials composed largely of sedimentary rocks can be processed using many of the same operations as for the plant stock. Often natural gas and oil are found in sedimentary rocks that were formed when grains and mineral particles were deposited by running water and fused together. Because these rocks are cemented together from such small components, they are porous, full of spaces in which energy-rich carbon compounds can settle, later to be liberated in the form of either oil or gas. Processing of reservoir materials begins with

operation **62** below. The processing after operation **62** replaces operations **1-13** discussed above relative to processing of plant stock.

(102) Operation **62** includes at least extracting reservoir materials such as shale, zeolite, and/or sandstone from petroleum and natural gas reservoir sources.

(103) Operation **63** includes at least delivering the reservoir materials **164** to a processing site at least in part with transporting equipment **163** (e.g., via conventional oil field transport vehicles or containers).

(104) Operation **64** includes at least milling the reservoir materials **164** with milling equipment **164** (e.g. a hammermill type machine followed by a rod ball mill to fluff the materials). Most reservoir materials are very friable and have a consistency of sand and may be oily to touch. These materials are easily milled as discussed above.

(105) Operation **65** includes at least transporting milled materials via transport equipment **165** (e.g., a auger feeder) to operation **15**.

(106) Operation **66** includes at least adding a flow aide additive to the milled materials in tandem with operation **65**. One flow aid would be trace amounts of silica.

(107) Operation **15** is discussed above relative to processing of plant stocks and applies similarly here regarding petroleum materials. Amount of added water (or other carrier liquid) varies dependent on composition of sands. And therefore the percent of sand by weight of the slurry will also vary.

(108) After operation **15**, processing of the reservoir materials proceeds to operations **16**, and **18-30** with modifications as discussed below. Unless otherwise indicated these operations are unchanged from as discussed above relative to plant stocks. However, in some embodiments operation **17** is not used for processing reservoir materials.

(109) At one or more of operations **20-22**, slurry is processed as discussed above.

(110) Combination of microwave treatment and wet-grinding reduces suspended particles in the slurry to 100 microns or less and causes release of petroleum chemicals in the suspended materials. These operations yield an off-gassed vapor including at least natural gas. This vapor is transported for processing according to operations **24-27** as discussed above. Additionally, at operation **28**, natural gas that is condensed from the vapor is stored (e.g., in tanks **128**) from where it can be transported to a natural gas facility.

(111) After processing in one or more of operations **20-22** the processed slurry moves to operation **29** as discussed above and then to operation **30**.

(112) Operation **30** proceeds as discussed above. With respect to the processed reservoir materials, operation **30** yields a liquid fraction that includes at least petroleum, a dry fraction that includes at least sand and other reservoir materials. For the wet fraction, processing moves to operation **71** reclamation, for example with reclamation tank **171**. For the dry fraction, processing moves via a transport operation **52** to operation **40** where crystals and other materials are a final product and processing ends. Alternatively, processing for the dry fraction moves to operations **56** (transport) and **57** (drying of sandstone, zeolite, and similar materials with drying system **155**) an end operation. Optionally, processing for the sandstone, zeolite, and similar materials may include operations **51** and **53** (wash and rinse), discussed above, and then to operation **57**.

II. Exemplary Wet-Grinding Apparatus with Microwave Unit-FIG. 2

(113) An exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **201** is now discussed with reference to FIG. 2. As is explained below, this wet-grinding apparatus includes one rotary disk **210** and one stator disk **209**. This embodiment may be compared with the wet-grinding apparatus of FIG. 4 which includes two stator disks.

(114) Referencing FIG. 2, a wet-grinding apparatus **201** includes at least a fluid conveyance **205** (e.g., slurry feed tube as shown) configured for receive and direct a slurry flow **206** (e.g., slurry feed) that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least suspended plant stock.

(115) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **201** further includes at least a high torque motor **221**

(refiner motor as shown) and a motor drive **204** operably coupled to be driven by the high torque motor **221**.

(116) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **201** further includes at least a set **217** of flat grinding disks (e.g., stator disk **209** and rotor disk **210**) that include at least one rotary disk **210** that is operably coupled to be driven by the motor drive **204** and that are configured, when the at least one rotor disk is receiving power via the motor drive, to accept the slurry flow **206**, to grind the suspended plant stock (e.g., plant parts **703** of FIG. 7), and to discharge the slurry flow **206**. In the exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **201** conveyance **205** is coupled with disk adjustment **219** and with stator disk **209**. Disk adjustment **219** adjusts a length of a portion **203** of conveyance **205** that determines how close stator disk **209** is to rotor disk **210**. When in operation only a thin layer of slurry should separate disks **209** and **210**. Slurry may then escape from conveyance **205** between disks **209** and **210** for grinding of the suspended plant stock between disks **209** and **210**.

(117) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **201** further includes at least a fluid outflow **218** configured to receive the discharged ground slurry flow **207** and to evacuate the ground slurry **207** (e.g., a commutated discharge slurry) flow to outside the wet-grinding apparatus **201**.

(118) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **201** further includes at least a microwave unit **220** that includes at least a microwave emitter **211** (e.g., a microwave (RF) magnetron unit) configured to emit microwave radiation toward the slurry (e.g., with microwave horn **212** (MW feed)).

Microwave radiation and off-gassed vapor are contained within chamber **208** by containment structure **202**. Off-gassed vapors are captured via negative atmospheric pressure within containment structure **202** by compressor **228** and directed toward vapor recovery unit **125** (e.g., at least a condenser).

(119) FIG. 2 further illustrates an enlarged side view of rotor disk **210**. However, the structures shown would be at least similar for stator disk **209**. Rotor disk **210** includes an axial hole **225**, a grinding surface **226**, an outer perimeter **227**, and grooves or slots **224** for assisting flow of slurry over the grinding surfaces **226**. In some embodiments grooves or slots are not present as they are not needed for processing of some raw materials.

III. Exemplary Standalone Microwave Unit-FIG. 3

(120) Referencing FIG. 3, an exemplary standalone microwave unit **120** is shown.

(121) Standalone microwave unit **120** is configured to provide microwave treatment in operation **20** of process **100** discussed above. But standalone microwave unit **120** could also function as microwave unit **122** to perform operation **22**.

(122) In some embodiments, an exemplary microwave unit is separate from a wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **201** or **401** of FIG. 4).

(123) The exemplary microwave unit **120** includes at least one or more high temperature-resistant conveyances **314** (e.g., tubes or pipes as shown, but could also be trays) that include at least one of tubes, coils, or troughs that are transparent to microwave radiation and that are further configured for receiving and conveying the slurry flow (e.g., slurry feed **306** and microwave-treated slurry **317**).

(124) The exemplary microwave unit **120** includes at least a microwave emitter **311** positioned to emit microwave radiation toward (e.g. via microwave horn **312**) at least a portion of the one or more conveyances **314**. The emitter **311** being coupled with microwave horn **312** for aiming the microwave radiation. The one or more conveyances **314** being at least partially disposed with a microwave containment structure **313** defining a chamber **315** for containing the microwave radiation and vapors off-gassed from slurry. Compressor **228** is configured for creating a negative atmosphere within chamber **313** and for siphoning off-gassed vapors toward vapor recovery **125** (e.g., of FIG. 1C).

(125) It being noted that when the microwave emitter is in operation the emitted microwave radiation cause cells **723** of the ground plant stocks within the one or more conveyances to expand thereby making a wet-grinding more effective (See discussion regarding FIG. 7 below).

IV. Exemplary Wet-Grinding Apparatus-FIG. 4

(126) An exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **401** is now discussed with reference to FIG. 4. As is explained below, this wet-grinding apparatus includes one rotary disk **410** and two stator disks **409A** and **409B**. This embodiment may be compared with the wet-grinding apparatus of FIG. 2 which includes one stator disks. This embodiment also differs from the wet-grinding apparatus **201** of FIG. 2 because it does not include a built-in microwave unit **220**. Instead, it includes a feed **328** from a microwave unit **120** and a feed **330** to microwave unit **122**.

(127) Referencing FIG. 4, a wet-grinding apparatus **401** includes at least a fluid conveyance **305** (e.g., slurry flow bringing microwave unit **120** of FIG. 3) configured for receive and direct a slurry flow that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least suspended plant stock (in some embodiments between 1% and 25% suspended plant stock by weight).

(128) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **401** further includes at least a high torque motor **421** (e.g., a vari-speed high torque electric motor) and a motor drive **404** operably coupled to be driven by the high torque motor **421**.

(129) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **401** further includes at least a set **417** of flat grinding disks (e.g., stator disks **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410**) that include at least one rotary disk **410** that is operably coupled to be driven by the motor drive **404** and that are configured, when the at least one rotor disk is receiving power via the motor drive **421**, to accept the slurry flow, to grind the suspended plant stock (e.g., plant parts **703** of FIG. 7), and to discharge the slurry flow. In the exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **401** mechanical adjusting drive **422** is configured to compress all disks (e.g., stator disks **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410**) to ride on thin films of slurry. When in operation only thin layers of slurry should separate stator disks **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410**. Slurry may then escape from conveyance **305** between stator disks **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410** for grinding of the suspended plant stock between **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410**.

(130) As discussed above, in some embodiments one or more of stator disks **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410** are composed of a steel alloy. In other embodiments one or more of stator disks **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410** are composed of stone or stone-like materials such as silicon carbide, aluminum oxide, zirconia, or ceramic friable mixes. In some embodiments one or more of stator disks **409A** and **409B** and rotor disk **410** are composed partly of a steel alloy, but with an attached stone facing to provide the grinding surfaces.

(131) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **401** further includes at least a fluid outflow **418** configured to receive the discharged ground slurry flow and to evacuate the ground slurry **407** flow to outside the wet-grinding apparatus **401**.

(132) The exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **401** is flowingly coupled (e.g. via feed **328**) to receive microwave-treated slurry from microwave unit **120**. This exemplary wet-grinding apparatus **401** is additionally flowingly coupled (e.g. via feed **330**) to provide ground slurry **407** to microwave unit **122**.

V. Process for Processing Invasive, Poisonous or Toxic Plant Stock-FIG. 5

(133) An exemplary process **500** for processing invasive, poisonous, and/or toxic plants into useful products is now described relative to FIG. 5.

(134) Referencing FIG. 5, operation **501** includes at least collecting at least one of fresh or dry plants. The collected plants could include many invasive, poisonous, and/or toxic plants, such as, for example, hemp, sage, white horse nettle, tumbleweed. The collected plants could also include combinations of one or of the above or of other plants.

(135) Operation **502** includes at least field reduction and transport of the collected plants. The field reduction could include primary reduction. In some embodiments primary reduction includes at least chopping the plants to one or more sizes in of approximately 6 inches. Transport could include transport via a transport container (e.g., **105** of FIG. 1A)

(136) Operation **503** includes at least receiving and storing the primary reduced plants from operation **502**. Stored plant stock may be stored open or closed depending on, for example, product

deposition.

(137) Operation **504** includes at least secondary reduction. This may include at least one of shredding, grinding or other volume reduction with reducing equipment (e.g., **107** of FIG. **1A**, which could be a rotary shear or a hammer mill, or other reducing equipment known to those skilled in the art). Operation **504** may also include removal of ferrous objects (e.g., ferrous metal debris) with removal equipment (e.g., magnets).

(138) Operation **505** includes at least tertiary reduction with tertiary reduction equipment (e.g., **111** of FIG. **1A**), such as a granulator or a knife mill. Additionally a hydro-pulper or high agitation mixer is used to add a carrier liquid (e.g., water from operation **506** below) to create a slurry that includes at least tertiary-reduced and suspended plant stock and the carrier liquid. In some embodiments, this carrier liquid is between 1% and 25% suspended plant stock by weight.

(139) Operation **506** includes at least providing water to a hydro-pulper of operation **505** (discussed above) and/or to fermentation operation **517** (discussed below). Water for operation **506** may be received from one or more of operations **510**, **515**, **516**, or **518** described below. Operation **506** may also include using a vapor recovery system to condense water vapor (produced in one or more of operations **510**, **515**, **516**, or **518**) into water.

(140) Operation **507** includes at least adding at least one of sugary food wastes, lignin, amalyse or other compounding additives to the slurry. This operation is dependent upon the plant stock being processed and the end products desired and may not be used in some embodiments.

(141) Operation **508** includes at least wet-grinding (e.g., may also be called micro-grinding) the slurry with or without microwave treatment. This operation is at least similar to operation **21** discussed above.

(142) Operation **509** includes at least separating the wet-ground slurry from operation **508** into a liquid fraction and wet fiber. This operation may be performed with separator apparatus **130** of FIG. **1D** (e.g., with one or more of a decanter, a basket centrifuge, or an SS Buchner funnel system). The liquid fraction may include chemicals such as oxalic acid or similar acids. The wet fiber may include fibrous plant stock residue. Processing of the liquid fraction moves forward with operation **510** (below) and processing of the wet fiber moves forward with operation **514** below.

(143) Operation **510** includes at least concentrating the liquids, such as liquid oxalic acid, via one or more of ultrasonic wave treatment, microwave radiation, and centrifugal methods. Vapors off-gassed from this operation are transported (e.g., via piping and/or tubing) to a vapor recovery operation associated with operation **506**.

(144) Operation **511** includes at least packaging of finished products from operation **510** such as oxalic acid.

(145) Operation **512** includes at least producing at least one of concentrates or granules. These products are packaged in operation **513**.

(146) Returning to processing of the wet fiber (process block **514**), operation **515** includes producing at least one of gluten-free dry powders or food pellets from at least a portion of the wet fiber produced in operation **509**. This operation includes at least drying the wet fiber.

(147) Operation **516** includes at least providing additives for producing pellets or granules from operation **515**.

(148) Operation **520** includes at least packaging the at least one of gluten-free dry powders or food pellets from operation **515** into final products.

(149) Operation **517** includes at least fermenting at least a portion of the wet fiber produced in operation **509**. Water is added via operation **506**. A fermented beverage is produced.

(150) Operation **518** includes at least decanting and distilling the fermented beverage of operation **517**.

(151) Operation **519** includes packaging and final preparation of at least one of ethanol and refined spirits.

(152) VI. Extractor-FIG. **6**

(153) Referencing FIG. 6, a simplified schematic drawing of an exemplary extractor **650** (also referred to as specific gravity extractor or a liquid concentrator) that may be used in operation **37** of FIG. 1E.

(154) Exemplary extractor **650** includes a tank **651** (e.g., a rectangular trough) filled with a liquid **666** to water level **665**. Raw extracted liquid density invasive feed **667** may be added to liquid with temperature of the feed **667** controlled by constant temperature controller unit **653** (e.g., with external or internal heated coils for maintaining constant temperature). An ultrasonic vibrating generating unit **668** produces ultrasonic vibrations of various frequencies. A specific retention time is used.

(155) Referencing feature **663**, the combination of the ultrasonic frequencies, the constant temperature, and the retention time result in a stratification of the liquid **666** into lighter and heavier liquids with different specific gravities. Heavier (higher density) liquids settle or stratify towards the bottom of tank **651**.

(156) In the particular exemplary extractor **650** showed, there are three submerged vertical drain pipes **655**, **656**, and **657** for draining liquids of different specific gravities. In the example shown drain pipe **655** is highest relative to floor **669** (for draining lightest specific gravity liquid), drain pipe **656** is of intermediate height relative to floor **669** (for draining moderate specific gravity liquid), and drain pipe **657** is of lowest height relative to floor **669** (for draining heavy specific gravity liquids). Referencing feature **662**, each of drain pipes **655**, **656**, and **657** are of adjustable height (relative to floor **669** of tank **651** by moving up or down relative to floor **669**) within a micron of height. Thus, extraction specific gravity tubes **655**, **656**, **657** (which may be multiple tube inserts depending on the extracted targeted substrates) are adjustable and controlled by outflow density fraction measurements.

(157) Drain pipes **655**, **656**, and **657** are associated with valves **658**, **659**, and **660**, respectively. That is, valve **658** is configured to extract light specific gravity liquid fractions from drain pipe **655**. Valve **659** is configured to extract medium specific gravity liquid fractions from drain pipe **656**. And valve **660** is configured to extract high specific gravity liquid fractions from drain pipe **657**. Collectively, pipes **655-657** and valves **658-660** are referred to as density-flow control meter and valve system **664**. The extracted liquid fractions from valves **658-660** are sent via individual vessel for further processing in, for example, one or more operations after operation **37** of process **100**. Conveyance **661** is configured for sending extracted fractions to their own individual vessels for further processing, such as in operation **44** of FIG. 1D.

(158) Exemplary extractor **650** includes an enclosure (not shown) to prevent escape of water vapors that evaporate from water **666** of tank **651**. A pump **128** may provide suction to move the captured water vapors via conveyance **654** to a vapor recovery system (e.g., vapor recovery unit **125** of FIG. 1C).

(159) VI. Process of Cell Fracture and Chemical Extraction-FIG. 7

(160) FIG. 7 illustrates a process **700** by which plant stock are processed, including processing by microwave treatment and stone commutation, to extract chemicals (e.g., oxalic acid and/or derivatives thereof) internal to the cells of the plant stock. That is, what occurs is a dynamic micron commutation of invasive plant's internal chemistry. Various stages (A-H) in the evolution of plant stock and plant cells are illustrated as they go through reduction, mixing into slurry, and processing by microwave treatment and stone commutation.

(161) Referencing FIG. 7, at stage A, plant stock **701** is received consisting of billions of cells.

(162) At stage B, plant stock **701** are chopped or ground (entire or part of plant) to yield plant pieces **702** of approximately ¼ inch in size.

(163) At stage C, plant pieces **703** are transported.

(164) At operation D, plant stock are mixed with water (or other carrier liquid) to form suspended plant particles **704**.

(165) The internal chemistry and typical cell structure of plant cell **705** (approximately 1-100

microns in size) is shown at stage E before microwave treatment and commutation. Plant cell structures include a golgi apparatus **706**, a centrosome **707**, cytoplasm **708**, ribosome **709**, lysosome **710**, smooth endoplasmic reticulum **711**, mitochondrion **712**, cytoskeleton **713**, membrane **714**, vesicle **715**, nucleolus **716**, nucleus **717**, and rough endoplasmic reticulum **718**. At stage E as plant cell **723** is shown before microwave treatment.

(166) At stage F, a swelling of a cell **722** is shown as swelling occurs during microwave exposure with internal outward pressure expansion.

(167) At stage G, a cell fracture **720** occurs commutation on a micro basis and there is release of the inherent chemistry. That is a release of the internal chemicals **721** of the cell into the liquid environment.

(168) At stage H, an empty cell **705** of an invasive target cell with internal chemistry removed is shown. What is left is fractured invasive plant fibers are microwave treatment and stone commutation.

(169) VII. Graphs Illustrating Efficiencies of Microwave Treatment and Stone Commutation of Plant Cells-FIGS. **8-10**

(170) Referencing FIG. **8**, shown is an exemplary graph **800** illustrating a progression of cellular chemical release with internal cell pressure build-up due to direct internal microwave attack to the cell's internal chemistry.

(171) Graph **800** includes a depiction of a flow **804** of slurry toward the microwave treatment and stone commutation operation and a flow outlet **805** after the outlet. Axis **801** (temperature) is vertical and increases upward relative to horizontal axis **807** (time). Axis **803** (extent of cell fracturing—from combination of cell swelling and stone commutation) also is vertical and increases upward relative to horizontal axis **807** (time). Also illustrated are microwave radiation waves **808** from microwave exposure **802** and plant cell **809** bombarded by the microwave radiation exposure **802**.

(172) Curve **806** illustrates the degree of chemical release of chemicals (e.g., oxalic acid) into a liquid environment. Curve **806** shows that the degree of chemical release is low near the intersection of axis **807** (time beginning), axis **801** (temperature low). Axis **803** (extent of cell fracturing) is also low. Curve **806** gradually increases showing release of internal cell chemistry and axis **807** (time), axis **801** (temperature), and axis **803** (degree of cell fracturing) all increase.

(173) Thus, overall it is illustrated that as time increases, temperature increases from microwave exposure, and cell fracturing increases, the chemical release of a plant cell's internal chemistry nears 100%.

(174) Referencing FIG. **9**, shown is a Graph **900** showing that a the number of days needed for plant stocks to ferment is reduced for plant stock process with the described microwave treatment/stone commutation process versus the number of days needed for plant stocks to ferment with conventional processing. The fermentation discussed in this Graph **900** is related to silage production as discussed above relative to operation **68** of process **100**.

(175) Graph **900** includes an intersection **911** of a vertical axis **902** representing advancing phases **1** thru **6** (**905-910**) and of a horizontal axis **901** showing time measured in days. Curve **904** represents fermentation by conventional processing as the value in both axis **902** and **901** increase. Curve **903** represents fermentation after plant stock has been treated by microwave treatment/micro-grind (i.e., wet-grind).

(176) Turning first to axis **902**, the phases start towards the bottom of the axis with phase 1-cell respiration (item **905**), then phase 2-production of acetic and lactic acid and ethanol (item **906**), then phase 3-lactic acid formation (item **907**), phase 4-additional lactic acid formation (item **908**), phase 5-material storage (item **909**), phase 6-aerobic decomposition and re-exposure to oxygen **910**.

(177) The pattern shown by Graph **900** is that curve **903** (wet fiber produced by microwave/micro-grind) rises faster than curve **904** (conventional processing). Thus, wet fiber that has been produced

in part by microwave processing and micro-grinding ferments quicker and more efficiently than plant fibers processed through conventional processing.

(178) Referencing FIG. 10, a Graph 1000 illustrates how much energy is required over a span of reaction time for processing with microwave/micro-grind versus conventional processing. Graph 1000 illustrates that over a span of reaction time less energy is required and released by processing with microwave/micro-grind versus conventional processing.

(179) Graph 1000 includes intersection 1005 of vertical axis 1002 representing increasing energy required and released and horizontal axis 1001 representing increasing reaction time. Solid curve 1003 represents energy required and released over time by conventional processing. Dotted curve 1004 represents energy required and released over time by microwave/micro-grind processing.

(180) As can be seen, curve 1003 rises higher than curve 1004 representing greater energy required and released by conventional processing versus microwave/micro-grind processing.

(181) Referencing FIG. 11, a Graph 1100 illustrates how much time and energy is required to achieve 100% total chemical release of chemicals stored in plant cells for microwave/micro-grind processing versus conventional processing. Graph 1100 illustrates that much less time and energy is required to achieve 100% total chemical release of chemicals stored in plant cells for microwave/micro-grind processing as compared with conventional processing. Graph 1100 also illustrates that temperatures rise higher with microwave/micro-grind processing.

(182) Graph 1100 illustrates intersection 1101 of vertical axis 1103 representing increasing temperature and horizontal axis 1102 representing increasing time and energy required. Horizontal axis 1102 also intersects vertical axis 1106 (parallel to axis 1103) representing increasing removal of oxalic acid and substrates. Dotted line 1104 which runs parallel to axis 1102 and perpendicular to axes 1103 and 1106 represents 100% total chemical release of chemicals (e.g., oxalic acid) from processed plant cells.

(183) Dotted curve 1107 representing processing by microwave/micro-grind starts at intersection 1101 and rises to dotted line 1104, showing that processing by microwave/micro-grind achieves 100% chemical release. Solid curve 1108 representing conventional processing also starts at intersection 1101 and rises gradually toward, but does not reach, dotted line 1104-illustrating that it does not achieve 100% total chemical release. Moreover, solid curve 1108 consumes more of axis 1102 indicating it consumes more time and energy to achieve a lesser state of chemical release relative to microwave/micro-grind processing.

(184) Thus, Graph 1100 illustrates that much less time and energy is required to achieve 100% total chemical release of chemicals stored in plant cells for microwave/micro-grind processing as compared with conventional processing. Graph 1100 also illustrates that temperatures rise higher with microwave/micro-grind processing.

(185) VIII. Flow Charts Illustrating One or More Processes-FIGS. 12-17

(186) FIG. 12 and the following figures include various examples of operational flows. Discussions and explanations may be provided with respect to the above-described principles, embodiments, and environments of FIGS. 1-11. However, the described operational flows may be executed and implemented in other environments and with different components.

(187) In addition, although the various operational flows are presented in illustrated sequences, it should be understood that in various embodiments the various operations may be performed in different sequential orders other than those which are illustrated, or may be performed concurrently or simultaneously.

(188) Further, in the following figures that depict various flow processes, various operations may be depicted in a box-within-a-box manner. Such depictions may indicate that an operation in an internal box may comprise an optional example embodiment of the operational step illustrated in one or more external boxes. However, it should be understood that internal box operations may be viewed as independent operations separate from any associated external boxes and may be performed in any sequence with respect to all other illustrated operations, or may be performed

concurrently. For additional clarity, some optional operations may be placed in broken line boxes.

(189) FIG. 12 illustrates a method **1200** for extracting useful products from at least one of invasive, poisonous or toxic plant stock, may consistent with some embodiments, include one or more of operations **1202**, **1204**, and **1206**. Collectively, operations **1202-1206** are at least similar to operation **21** of FIG. 1C.

(190) Referencing FIG. 12, in some embodiments operation **1202** regarding conveying the slurry includes at least conveying a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some plant stock suspended in the one or more carrier liquids, the conveying being performed at least in part with a fluid conveyance of a wet-grinding apparatus. In some embodiments, operation **1202** may be implemented with at least a wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., wet-grinding apparatus **121** of FIGS. 1C, **201** of FIGS. 2, and/or **421** of FIG. 4) that includes at least a fluid conveyance (e.g., **205** of FIG. 2) configured for receive and direct a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least suspended plant stock suspended in the one or more carrier liquids.

(191) Consistent with some embodiments, operation **1204** includes at least driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry on one or more surfaces, to grind the suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry. In some embodiments, operation **1204** may be implemented with at least a wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., wet-grinding apparatus of FIGS. 1C and 2 or **421** of FIG. 4) that includes at least a set of flat grinding disks (e.g., **217** of FIG. 2, **417** of FIG. 4) that include at least one rotor disk (e.g., **210**, **410**) that is operably coupled to be driven by the motor drive (e.g., motor drive **204** driven by high torque motor **221**), the set configured, when the at least one rotor disk is driven by the motor drive, to accept the slurry from the fluid conveyance **205**, to grind the suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry.

(192) Consistent with some embodiments, operation **1206** includes at least emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus. In some embodiments, operation **1204** may be implemented with at least a microwave unit (e.g., **220** of FIG. 2, and/or microwave units **120**, **122**) that includes at least one microwave emitter (e.g., **211**, **311**) configured to emit microwave radiation toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the slurry is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **121**, **201**, and/or **401**).

(193) Referencing FIG. 13, in some embodiments operation **1204** regarding wet-grinding the slurry optionally includes one or more of operations **1305**, **1307**, **1308**, or **1310**.

(194) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1305** includes at least driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding stones with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor at a torque in a range between 10.5 foot-pounds and 11,000 foot-pounds. In some embodiments operation **1305** is implemented at least with a high torque motor (e.g., **221**) that is configured to provide torque in a range between 10.5 foot-pounds and 11,000 foot-pounds.

(195) Consistent with some embodiments, operation **1307** includes at least driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding stones with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor operating at between 60 rpm and 1,800 rpm. In some embodiments, operation **1307** is implemented at least with a high torque motor (e.g., **221**) that is configured to operate at one or more speeds between 60 rpm and 1,800 rpm.

(196) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1308** includes at least driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks that includes at least one of a stone disk, a steel alloy disc, or a disk composed in part of stone and in part of steel alloy. In some embodiments, operation **1308** is implemented at least in part with set of flat grinding disks (e.g., **217**, **417**) that includes at least one of a stone disk, a steel alloy disc, or a disk composed in part of stone and in part of steel alloy.

(197) In some embodiments, operation **1308** optionally includes operation **1309**.

(198) Consistent with some embodiments, operation **1309** includes at least driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks that includes at least one flat grinding stone composed at least partly of at least one of silicon carbide, aluminum oxide, zirconia, or ceramic friable mixes. In some embodiments, operation **1309** is implemented at least with set of flat grinding disks (e.g. disks **210**, **209** of set **217**) includes at least one flat grinding disk composed at least partly of at least one of silicon carbide, aluminum oxide, zirconia, or ceramic friable mixes.

(199) Consistent with some embodiments, operation **1310** includes at least driving at least one rotor stone of a set of flat grinding stones, the flat grinding stones including at least two stator stones and the at least one rotor stone, the individual flat grinding stones being aligned along respective axial holes about the motor drive, the driving including at least driving the at least one rotating stone with the high torque motor, the driving causing the slurry (**1**) to be received via the respective axially aligned holes from the fluid conveyance, (**2**) to be directed onto flat grinding surfaces of the individual flat grindings stones, (**3**) to be ground while the suspended plant stock is in solution in the slurry, and (**4**) to be discharged from outer perimeters defined by the individual flat grindings stones of the set of flat grinding stones. In some embodiments operation **1310** is implemented with at least a set of flat grinding stones (e.g., **217**, **417**), the set of flat grinding stones including at least two stator stones (e.g., **409A**, **409B**) and at least one rotor stone (e.g., **210**, **410**), the individual flat grinding stones being aligned along respective axial holes (e.g., **225**) about the motor drive (e.g., **204**, **404**), the at least one rotor stone being configured to be driven by the high torque motor via the motor drive, and wherein when the at least one rotor stone is driven by the high torque motor the set of flat grinding stones is configured to receive the slurry via the respective axially aligned holes from the fluid conveyance, to direct slurry onto flat grinding surfaces (e.g., **226** of FIG. 2) of the individual flat grindings stones of the set, to grind the suspended plant stock while it is in solution in the slurry, and to discharge the slurry from outer perimeters (e.g., **227** of FIG. 2) defined by the individual flat grinding stones of the set of flat grinding stones.

(200) Referencing FIG. 14, in some embodiments operation **1206** regarding microwaving the slurry optionally includes one or more of operations **1412**, **1414**, **1416**, **1418**, **1424** or **1426**.

(201) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1412** regarding microwaving the slurry includes at least emitting, with the at least one microwave emitter, at least some microwave radiation in a range between 300 GHz and 300 MHz. In some embodiments operation **1412** is implemented with at least at least one microwave emitter (e.g., **211**, **411**) is configured to emit at least some microwave radiation in a range between 300 GHz and 300 MHz.

(202) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1414** regarding microwaving the slurry includes at least emitting, with the at least one microwave emitter, at least some microwave radiation with a photon energy between 1.24 to 1.24 micro electron volts. In some embodiments operation **1414** is implemented with at least at least one microwave emitter (e.g., **211**, **411**) is configured to emit at least some microwave radiation with a photon energy between 1.24 to 1.24 micro electron volts.

(203) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1416** includes at least emitting the microwave radiation within a containment structure configured to contain the microwave radiation and gases off-gassed from the slurry during microwave radiation treatment, creating a negative atmosphere between 760 and 10⁻⁹ torr within the containment structure with a compressor, and converting the off-gassed gases to liquid form for capture with at least a vapor recovery unit that includes at least one condenser. In some embodiments operation **1416** is implemented at least with a microwave unit that includes at least a containment structure (e.g., **202** of FIGS. 2 and/or **313** of FIG. 3) configured to contain the microwave radiation and gases off-gassed from the slurry during microwave radiation treatment and a compressor (e.g., **223** of FIGS. 2 and/or **323** of FIG. 3) configured for creating a negative atmosphere between 760 and 10⁻⁹ torr in the containment structure. And operation **1415** being further implemented with a vapor recovery unit (e.g., **125**) that

includes at least one compressor for converting the off-gassed gases to liquid form for capture.

(204) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1418** includes at least conveying the slurry through one or more high temperature-resistant conveyances that include at least one of tubes, coils, or troughs that are transparent to microwave radiation, and emitting, with the at least one microwave emitter, microwave radiation toward at least a portion of the one or more conveyances, wherein the emitting of microwave radiation causes cells of the ground plant stocks in the slurry within the one or more conveyances to expand thereby making a wet-grinding more effective. In some embodiments operation **1418** is implemented at least with a microwave unit (e.g., microwave unit **120** of FIG. **3**) is separate from the wet-grinding apparatus and that includes at least one or more high temperature-resistant conveyances (e.g., **314**) that include at least one of tubes, coils, or troughs that are transparent to microwave radiation and that are further configured for receiving and conveying the slurry and wherein the microwave emitter is positioned to emit microwave radiation (e.g., with microwave emitter **311** and Horn **312**) toward at least a portion of the one or more conveyances, and wherein when the microwave emitter is in operation the emitted microwave radiation cause cells of the ground plant stocks within the one or more conveyances to expand thereby making a wet-grinding more effective.

(205) In some embodiments, operation **1418** optionally includes one or more of operation **1420** or **1422**.

(206) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1420** includes at least emitting the microwave radiation toward at least the portion of the one or more conveyances before processing of the slurry in the wet-grinding apparatus and after the emitting of the microwave radiation, conveying the slurry, to an intake of the wet-grinding apparatus. In some embodiments operation **1420** is implemented with at least one or more one or more conveyances (**314**) that are configured to receive the slurry for exposure to the microwave radiation (e.g., from microwave emitter **311**) before processing in the wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **201** or **401**) and are further configured to convey the slurry, after exposure to microwave radiation to the fluid conveyance (e.g., **205**, **405**) of the wet-grinding apparatus.

(207) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1422** includes at least receiving the slurry in the one or more conveyances for exposure to microwave radiation after grinding in the wet-grinding apparatus and emitting the microwave radiation toward at least the portion of the one or more conveyances. In some embodiments operation **1422** is implemented with at least one or more conveyances (**314**) are configured to receive the slurry for exposure to the microwave radiation after grinding in the wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **201** or **401**).

(208) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1424** includes at least emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter of a microwave unit that is operating in at least one of a batch, batch-continuous or a continuous operation mode. In some embodiments operation **1424** is implemented at least with a microwave unit (e.g., **120** or **220**) that is configured to operate in at least one of a batch, batch-continuous or a continuous operation mode.

(209) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1426** includes at least emitting the microwave radiation toward the slurry while the slurry is at least partially within the wet-grinding apparatus, the wet-grinding apparatus being encased in an encasement configured for containing the microwave radiation and wherein the emitting of the microwave radiation toward the slurry causes cell fibers within the slurry to expand and thereby increase an effectiveness of grinding. In some embodiments operation **1426** is implemented with at least microwave unit (e.g., unit **220** of FIG. **2**) is at least partially integrated as a portion of the wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **201**), the microwave unit including at least a the microwave emitter (**211**) configured to emit microwave radiation toward the slurry and an encasement (**202**) configured to encase the wet-grinding apparatus during microwave emissions and wherein the microwave radiation causes cell fibers within the slurry to expand and thereby increasing effectiveness of grinding.

(210) Referencing FIGS. **15A** and **15B**, in some embodiments method **1200** optionally further

includes one or more of additional operations **1530**, **1532**, **1534**, or **1536**.

(211) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1530** includes at least primarily reducing a volume of plant stock by at least one of shredding or chopping the plant stock into pieces of less than 6 inches in length.

(212) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1532** includes at least secondarily reducing a volume of plant stock that has previously undergone primary reduction by at least one of shredding or compacting the plant stock with at least one of a rotary shear, a compactor, or a hammer mill. In some embodiments operation **1532** is implemented at least with secondary reducing equipment (e.g., **107** of FIG. **1A**), including at least one of a rotary shear a compactor, or a hammer mill, configured to at least one of shred or compact plant stock that has previously undergone primary reduction, thereby reducing its volume to produce compacted plant stock for transport.

(213) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1534** includes at least tertiary reducing plant stock with at least one of a granulator, a grinder, or a knife mill to further reduce secondarily reduced plant stock to reduce the plant stock to a particle size adapted for wet-grinding with wet-grinding apparatus. In some embodiments operation **1534** is implemented at least with tertiary reducing equipment (e.g., **111** of FIG. **1A**), including at least one of a granulator, a grinder, or a knife mill, configured for further reducing secondarily reduced plant stock to render plant stock to a particle size adapted for wet-grinding with wet-grinding apparatus.

(214) In some embodiments, operation **1534** optionally includes operation **1535**.

(215) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1535** includes at least capturing air-suspended particles escaping from tertiary reduction of plant stock with at least one of a cyclone or a baghouse. In some embodiments operation **1535** is implemented with at least air-cleaning system (e.g., **112** of FIG. **1A**) configured to capture air-suspended particles escaping from tertiary reduction of plant stock, the air-cleaning system including at least one of a cyclone or a baghouse.

(216) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1536** includes at least receiving the one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in one or more containers and mixing said one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in said one or more containers to form a slurry of which the suspended plant stock is between 1% and 25% by weight. In some embodiments operation **1536** may be implemented with at least a mixing apparatus (**115** of FIG. **1B**—e.g., hydra-pulper or high agitation mixer) configured for receiving the one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in one or more containers and is further configured for mixing said one or more carrier liquids and the reduced plant stock in said one or more containers to form a slurry of which suspended plant stock is between 1% and 25% by weight.

(217) In some embodiments, operation **1536** optionally includes one or more of operations **1538**, **1540**, or **1542**.

(218) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1538** includes at least mixing said one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock with at least one of a hydro-pulper or a high-agitation mixer. In some embodiments operation **1538** may be implemented with at least a mixing apparatus (e.g., **115**) that includes at least one of a hydro-pulper or a high-agitation mixer for performing at least a portion of the mixing.

(219) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1540** includes at least at least partially separating, with a centrifugal separator, at least one of earthly inerts or non-plant materials from the slurry. In some embodiments operation **1540** may be implemented with at least a mixing apparatus (e.g., **115**) that further includes at least a centrifugal separator configured for at least partially separating at least one of earthly inerts or non-plant materials from the slurry.

(220) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1542** includes at least mixing into at least one of the one or more carrier liquids or the slurry at least one of a surfactant, an additive, vegetation containing sugars, or an amylase type additive. In some embodiments operation **1542** may be implemented with at least a mixing apparatus (**115**) is further configured to receive and to mix into at least one of the one or more carrier liquids or the slurry at least one of a surfactant, an additive,

vegetation containing sugars, or an amylase type additive.

(221) Referencing FIG. **16**, in some embodiments method **1200** optionally further includes one or more of additional operations **1643**, **1655**, **1656**, or **1660**.

(222) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1643** includes at least separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products. In some embodiments operation **1643** may be implemented with at least a separator apparatus (**130** of FIG. **1D**—e.g., one or more of a decanter, a basket centrifuge, or an SS Buchner funnel system) configured to separate the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products.

(223) In some embodiments operation **1643** optionally includes one or more of operations **1644**, **1646**, **1648**, **1650**, **1652**, or **1654**.

(224) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1644** includes at least separating the slurry at least in part with a separator apparatus that includes at least one of a decanting centrifuge, a basket centrifuge, or an SS Buchner Funnel method. In some embodiments operation **1644** may be implemented with at least a separator apparatus (e.g., **130**) includes at least one of a decanting centrifuge, a basket centrifuge, or an SS Buchner Funnel system.

(225) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1646** includes at least directing ultrasonic waves having a frequency between 20 Hz and 200 Mhz toward the slurry, wherein the ultrasonic waves aid separation of the slurry into the liquid fraction and the wet fiber. In some embodiments operation **1646** may be implemented with at least an ultrasonic emitter (e.g., where separator apparatus **130** includes an ultrasonic emitter) configured to direct ultrasonic waves having a frequency between 20 Hz and 200 Mhz toward the slurry, wherein the ultrasonic waves aid separation of the slurry in the liquid fraction and the wet fiber.

(226) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1648** includes at least separating the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products that include at least one of gluten-free flour, pellets for agricultural feed, fillers for foodstuffs, plastics, adhesives, ethanol, or distilled spirits. In some embodiments operation **1648** may be implemented with at least a separator apparatus (e.g., **130**) configured to separate the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products that include at least one of gluten-free flour (e.g., **160**), pellets for agricultural feed (e.g., **161**), fillers for foodstuffs, plastics, adhesives, ethanol (e.g., **146**), or distilled spirits (e.g., **147**).

(227) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1650** includes at least separating the slurry into a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products that include at least one of a pesticide, an insecticide or a fungicide. In some embodiments operation **1650** may be implemented with at least a separator apparatus (e.g. **130**) configured to separate the slurry into a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products that include at least one of a pesticide, an insecticide or a fungicide (e.g., liquids **141** of FIG. **1F**).

(228) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1652** includes at least separating the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into at least one of liquid, solid, crystal, powdery, granular, or oily products. In some embodiments operation **1652** may be implemented with at least a separator apparatus (e.g. **130**) configured to separate the slurry into a liquid fraction and a wet fiber that are suitable for further processing into one or more products that include at least one of liquid (e.g., **141**, **146**, **147**), solid (**141**), crystal (**141**), powdery (**161**), granular, or oily (**141**) products.

(229) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1654** includes at least separating the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more materials that can be blended with at least one of an organic material, a dry material, a wet material, or a liquid to produce one or more complex compounds. In some embodiments operation **1654** may be implemented with at least a separator apparatus (e.g. **130**) configured to separate the slurry into a liquid fraction and a wet fiber

that are suitable for further processing into one or more products that can be blended with at least one of an organic material, a dry material, a wet material, or a liquid to produce one or more complex compounds.

(230) As discussed above relative to FIG. **16**, in some embodiments method **1200** may optionally include one or more of additional operations **1655**, **1656**, or **1660**.

(231) In some embodiments operation **1655** includes at least extracting at least one of an oxalic acid fraction, an oxalic salt fraction, or organic compounds from the liquid fraction with at least one of ultrasonic settling, centrifuging, or liquid-liquid separation. In some embodiments operation **1655** may be implemented with at least an extractor (e.g., **137**, and/or extractor **650**) that is configured to accept the liquid fraction separated by the separator apparatus and extract at least one of an oxalic acid fraction, an oxalic salt fraction, or organic compounds from the liquid fraction with at least one of ultrasonic setting, centrifuging, or liquid-liquid separation.

(232) In some embodiments operation **1656** includes at least directing germicidal ultraviolet light radiation toward at least one of the slurry, the liquid fraction or the wet fiber, wherein the ultraviolet light is configured to reduce a risk of at least one of bacterial or fungal growth. In some embodiments operation **1656** is implemented with at least an ultraviolet light chamber (e.g., **131** and/or **154** of FIG. **1D**) configured with an ultraviolet emitter (not shown) for directing germicidal ultraviolet light radiation toward at least one of the slurry, the liquid fraction or the wet fiber, wherein the ultraviolet light is configured to reduce a risk of at least one of bacterial or fungal growth.

(233) Further referencing FIG. **16**, in some embodiments operation **1656** optionally includes operation **1658**).

(234) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1658** includes at least directing at least some ultraviolet waves of the ultraviolet light waves that have one or more wave lengths in a range between 100 and 2809 nanometers. In some embodiments operation **1658** is implemented with at least an ultraviolet light chamber (e.g., **131** and/or **154** of FIG. **1D**) configured with an ultraviolet emitter (not shown) for directing at least some ultraviolet waves of the ultraviolet light waves that have one or more wave lengths in a range between 100 and 2809 nanometers.

(235) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1660** includes at least creating a negative atmosphere in one or more chambers containing at least some of the slurry to facilitate capture of at least some light volatiles escaping from at least one of the slurry or the extracted liquid fraction and converting at least some of the captured light volatiles into one or more liquid forms. In some embodiments operation **1660** may be implemented with at least a vapor recovery unit (e.g., **125** of FIG. **1C**) that includes at least one or more conveyances for conveying off-gassed vapors escaping from at least one of the slurry or the liquid fraction and a compressor configured to receive the off-gassed vapors from the one or more conveyances and to convert the off-gassed vapors into one or more liquid forms.

(236) It is noted that in some embodiments of at least one of an invasive, a poisonous or a toxic plant stock includes at least one of tumbleweed (*salsula targus*), kudzu, rosemary bean (*Abrus precatorius*) or sage brush plant stock.

(237) FIG. **17** is a flow chart illustrating an exemplary method **1700** for extracting useful products from petroleum reservoir materials. Consistent with some embodiments method **1700** includes operations **1702**, **1704**, **1706** and optionally operation **1708**. It is noted that these operations may be implemented with at least some of the equipment discussed above relative to method **1200**.

(238) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1702** includes at least conveying a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some petroleum-reservoir materials suspended in the one or more carrier liquids, the conveying being performed at least in part with a fluid conveyance of a wet-grinding apparatus. In some embodiments operation **1702** may be implemented with at least a wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **201** of FIGS. **2** and/or **401** of FIG. **4**) that includes at least a fluid conveyance (e.g., **205** of FIG. **2**) configured for receive and direct a slurry

that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some petroleum-reservoir materials suspended in the one or more carrier liquids.

(239) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1704** includes at least driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry onto one or more grinding surfaces of individual grinding disks of the set of flat grinding disks, to grind the suspended petroleum-based reservoir materials, and to discharge the slurry. In some embodiments operation **1704** may be implemented with at least a wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **201** of FIGS. **2** and/or **401** of FIG. **4**) that includes at least a high torque motor, a motor drive operably coupled to be driven by the high torque motor, and a set (e.g., **217** of FIGS. **2** and/or **417** of FIG. **4**) of flat grinding disks that include at least one rotor disk (e.g., **210** and/or **410**) that is operably coupled to be driven by the motor drive (e.g., motor drive **204** driven by high torque motor **221**), the set configured, when the at least one rotor disk is driven by the motor drive, to accept the slurry from the fluid conveyance, to grind the suspended petroleum-reservoir materials, and to discharge the slurry.

(240) Consistent with some embodiments operation **1706** includes at least emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the suspended petroleum-reservoir materials are ground by the wet-grinding apparatus. In some embodiments operation **1706** may be implemented with at least a microwave unit (e.g., **220** of FIG. **2**, and/or microwave units **120**, **122**) that includes at least one microwave emitter (e.g., **211**, **311**) configured to emit microwave radiation toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the slurry is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus (e.g., **121**, **201**, and/or **401**).

(241) Optionally, method **1700** includes operation **1708**, includes at least separating the slurry into (1) a solid residue and (2) a petroleum liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more petroleum-based products. This operation is performed with separator apparatus **130** (e.g. one or more of a decanter, a basket centrifuge, or an SS Buchner funnel system).

(242) In addition to the above disclosure, the following discussion is provided: 1. The additives for pharmaceuticals and supplements either whole or partial. 2. Derivatives from invasive plants discussed in this document could be excellent surfactants or cleaners for many various types of metals and nonmetals. Potential uses include for electronics, chemical plants, normal household usage, and commercial and industrial applications. 3. These derivatives could also be used for biological control services or for an aerosol, or liquid for controlling various vectors such as bacteria and microbes. The derivatives may be very effective in controlling or eliminating germs such as corona type viruses. Many other unexplored and new biological germs may not yet discovered. 4. Kudzu is an invasive plant brought here by the Corps of Engineers to help erosion control. It has gotten wildly out of control but can be an excellent source of food. It has inherent derivatives for use in many products. Therefore, harvesting this plant under controlled conditions provides an economical food source. It could also be useful as application as a filler in commercial, agricultural, pharmacal and industrial products. 5. Reference is made to Toxic Plants of North America, Second Edition by George E Burrous and Ronald J. Tyrl, which describes many plants that present opportunities in the medical and chemical fields, along with their derivatives. 6. Plants such as the very poisonous variety, may be excellent for controlling certain diseases in a natural manner and not synthetically derived. These plants could be used as a supplement or as an additive to existing chemicals to achieve a higher in purpose of effectiveness. Additionally, these invasive plants may have a great value, being naturally occurring, with shorter half-lives and therefore not remaining in the environment. 7. It may be desirable to separate the various parts of the plants such as the leaves, the stems or the flowers for higher benefits for various applications. Example is the Roseberry bean (*arbus precatorius*) is known to kill some plants that may be undesirable or noxious. It may be an excellent replacement for commercial week-killers that are derived from

synthetically-derived chemicals. 8. It is noted that in some embodiments the MW-micro grind systems herein described can be a plurality of machines operating in series or in parallel depending or both on the circumstances of the materials being processed. Additionally, the feedstock or slurry being may be recycled back through a process at certain points to for production of certain products. Combinations of various types of plants may be processed at the same time. 9. The plants described in this document generally have extensive chemical complexes that are not easily synthesized in the lab. Therefore, the systems and processes described in this document provide plant-derived products with superior properties as compared with synthetically derived chemicals, providing potential for applications in the medical industrial and commercial fields. 10. Plants such as those described in this document can have significant derivatives and substrates for products such as plastics, textiles, binders for construction, glues or adhesives etc. 11. Unlike the other technologies, the microwave and micro-grind technologies described herein preserve a plants composite composition. They allow for removal of portions such as the fibers that can be effective and useful for use as a food application or other applications. 12. Processes described herein allow for reprocessing the end products to produce more affective products. For example, fiber remaining from the extracted plant could be re-processed to another form or treated in a different manner. 13. Upon receiving plants at a processing site, they may be enclosed in a contained area and treated with various gases, ultraviolet light or microwaves to enhance their prepare the for further processing according to operations described herein. 14. It should be noted that when a mixture of some plant-derived, prepared solutions, are allowed to stand for extended an extended period of time, this may cause the overall mixture to form molds that may have very excellent properties for many applications. 15. When preparing a solution not using a grind process and only using extreme heat over a prolonged time, it has been found that this may cause the solution to lose many of its inherent properties due to excessive heat and time. 16. At operation 5 of FIG. 1A, the plant feed stock can be stored and prepared in a gaseous or spray atmosphere to enhance the overall efficiency of method 100. The gases used may include oxygen, nitrogen, or other prepared gases and spray ingredients, such as acids, caustic substances, to nutrients or extracts from the process. 17. At operation 21, the refined material can be processed in parallel or series and/or recycled for reprocessing during the micro-grinding or shearing process. 18. At operation 30, there are many types of fluid separators for separating solids to liquid. 19. At operation 37, various separating equipment devices can be employed depending on the material(s) being processed and many types of light sources or gravitational instruments can be employed.

(243) It will be understood by those skilled in the art that the terminology used in this specification and in the claims is “open” in the sense that the terminology is open to additional elements not enumerated. For example, the words “includes” should be interpreted to mean “including at least” and so on. Even if “includes at least” is used sometimes and “includes” is used other times, the meaning is the same: includes at least. In addition, articles such as “a” or “the” should be interpreted as not referring to a specific number, such as one, unless explicitly indicated. At times a convention of “at least one of A, B, or C” is used, the intent is that this language includes any of A alone, B alone, C alone, A and B, B and C, A and C, all of A, B, and C, or any combination thereof. The same is indicated by the conventions “one of more of A, B, or C.” Similarly, the phrase “A, B, and/or C” is intended to include any of A alone, B alone, C alone, A and B, B and C, A and C, all of A, B, and C or any combination thereof.

(244) And as previously indicated elements, components, or operations should not be regarded as essential unless they are so explicitly described. The teachings contained herein may be adapted to a variety of embodiments arranged and composed in a wide variety of ways.

(245) The above description of various embodiments is intended to be illustrative not exhaustive and is not intended to limit this disclosure, its application, or uses. Those skilled in the art will be able to imagine embodiments not described but that are consistent with the principles and teachings described herein. Therefore, the above description of exemplary embodiments is not intended to

limit the scope of this disclosure, which should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and equivalents thereof.

Claims

1. A method for extracting useful products from at least one of invasive, poisonous or toxic plant stock, the method comprising: conveying a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some plant stock suspended in the one or more carrier liquids, the conveying being performed at least in part with a fluid conveyance of a wet-grinding apparatus; driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry on one or more surfaces, to grind the suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry; and emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry while, the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor comprises: driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding stones with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor at a torque in a range between 10.5 foot-pounds and 11,000 foot-pounds.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor comprises: driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding stones with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor operating at between 60 rpm and 1,800 rpm.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor comprises: driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks that includes at least one of a stone disk, a steel alloy disc, or a disk composed in part of stone and in part of steel alloy.
5. The method of claim 4, wherein the driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks that includes at least one of a stone disk, a steel alloy disc, or a disk composed in part of stone and in part of steel alloy comprises: driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks that includes at least one flat grinding stone composed at least partly of at least one of silicon carbide, aluminum oxide, zirconia, or ceramic friable mixes.
6. The method of claim 2, wherein the driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry on one or more surfaces, to grind the suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry comprises: driving at least one rotor stone of a set of flat grinding stones, the flat grinding stones including at least two stator stones and the at least one rotor stone, the individual flat grinding stones being aligned along respective axial holes about the motor drive, the driving including at least driving the at least one rotating stone with the high torque motor, the driving causing the slurry (1) to be received via the respective axially aligned holes from the fluid conveyance, (2) to be directed onto flat grinding surfaces of the individual flat grindings stones, (3) to be ground while the suspended plant stock is in solution in the slurry, and (4) to be discharged from outer perimeters defined by the individual flat grindings stones of the set of flat grinding stones.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry while the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus comprises: emitting, with the at least one microwave emitter, at least some microwave radiation in a range between 300 GHz and 300 MHz.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein the emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry while the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-

grinding apparatus comprises: emitting, with the at least one microwave emitter, at least some microwave radiation with a photon energy of between 1.24 to -1.24 micro electron volts.

9. A method for extracting useful products from at least one of invasive, poisonous or toxic plant stock, the method comprising: conveying a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some plant stock suspended in the one or more carrier liquids, the conveying being performed at least in part with a fluid conveyance of a wet-grinding apparatus; driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry on one or more surfaces, to grind the suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry; and emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus, wherein the emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus comprises: emitting the microwave radiation within a containment structure configured to contain the microwave radiation and gases off-gassed from the slurry during microwave radiation treatment; creating a negative atmosphere between 760 and 10-9 torr within the containment structure with a compressor; and converting the off-gassed gases to liquid form for capture with at least a vapor recovery unit that includes at least one condenser.

10. The method of claim 1, wherein the emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry while the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus comprises: conveying the slurry through one or more high temperature-resistant conveyances that include at least one of tubes, coils, or troughs that are transparent to microwave radiation; and emitting, with the at least one microwave emitter, microwave radiation toward at least a portion of the one or more conveyances, wherein the emitting of microwave radiation causes cells of the ground plant stocks in the slurry within the one or more conveyances to expand thereby making a wet-grinding more effective.

11. The method of claim 10, further comprising: emitting the microwave radiation toward at least the portion of the one or more conveyances before processing of the slurry in the wet-grinding apparatus; and after the emitting of the microwave radiation, conveying the slurry, to an intake of the wet-grinding apparatus.

12. The method of claim 10, further comprising: receiving the slurry in the one or more conveyances for exposure to microwave radiation after grinding in the wet-grinding apparatus; and emitting the microwave radiation toward at least the portion of the one or more conveyances.

13. The method of claim 1, wherein the emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry while the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus comprises: emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter of a microwave unit that is operating in at least one of a batch, batch-continuous or a continuous operation mode.

14. The method of claim 1, wherein the emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward the slurry, while the slurry is being ground by the wet-grinding apparatus comprises: emitting the microwave radiation toward the slurry while the slurry is at least partially within the wet-grinding apparatus, the wet-grinding apparatus being encased in an encasement configured for containing the microwave radiation; and wherein the emitting of the microwave radiation toward the slurry causes cell fibers within the slurry to expand and thereby increase an effectiveness of grinding.

15. The method of claim 1, wherein the method further comprises: primarily reducing a volume of plant stock by at least one of shredding or chopping the plant stock into pieces of less than 6 inches in length.

16. The method of claim 15, wherein the method further comprises: secondarily reducing a volume of plant stock that has previously undergone primary reduction by at least one of shredding or

compacting the plant stock with at least one of a rotary shear, a compactor, or a hammer mill.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein the method further comprises: tertiaryly reducing plant stock with at least one of a granulator, a grinder, or a knife mill to further reduce secondarily reduced plant stock to reduce the plant stock to a particle size adapted for wet-grinding with wet-grinding apparatus.

18. The method of claim 17, wherein the tertiaryly reducing plant stock with at least one of a granulator, a grinder, or a knife mill to further reduce secondarily reduced plant stock to reduce the plant stock to a particle size adapted for wet-grinding with wet-grinding apparatus comprises: capturing air-suspended particles escaping from tertiary reduction of plant stock with at least one of a cyclone or a baghouse.

19. The method of claim 1, wherein the method further comprises: receiving the one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in one or more containers; mixing said one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in said one or more containers to form a slurry of which the suspended plant stock is between 1% and 25% by weight.

20. The method of claim 19, wherein the mixing said one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in said one or more containers to form a slurry of which the suspended plant stock is between 1% and 25% by weight comprises: mixing said one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock with at least one of a hydro-pulper or a high-agitation mixer.

21. The method of claim 19, wherein the mixing said one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in said one or more containers to form a slurry of which the suspended plant stock is between 1% and 25% by weight comprises: at least partially separating, with a centrifugal separator, at least one of earthly inerts or non-plant materials from the slurry.

22. The method of claim 19, wherein the mixing said one or more carrier liquids and reduced plant stock in said one or more containers to form a slurry of which the suspended plant stock is between 1% and 25% by weight comprises: mixing into at least one of the one or more carrier liquids or the slurry at least one of a surfactant, an additive, vegetation containing sugars, or an amylase type additive.

23. The method of claim 1, wherein the method further comprises: separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products.

24. A method for extracting useful products from at least one of invasive, poisonous or toxic plant stock, the method comprising: conveying a slurry that contains at least one or more carrier liquids and at least some plant stock suspended in the one or more carrier liquids, the conveying being performed at least in part with a fluid conveyance of a wet-grinding apparatus; driving at least one rotor disk of a set of flat grinding disks of the wet-grinding apparatus with a motor drive operably coupled with a high torque motor, the driving causing the set of flat grinding disks to accept the slurry on one or more surfaces, to grind the suspended plant stock, and to discharge the slurry; emitting microwave radiation, with at least one microwave emitter, toward at least a portion of the slurry at least one of before, while, or after the suspended plant stock is ground by the wet-grinding apparatus; and separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products, wherein the separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products comprises: separating the slurry at least in part with a separator apparatus that includes at least one of a decanting centrifuge, a basket centrifuge, or an SS Buchner Funnel method.

25. The method of claim 23, wherein the method further comprises: extracting at least one of an oxalic acid fraction, an oxalic salt fraction, or organic compounds from the liquid fraction with at least one of ultrasonic settling, centrifuging, or liquid-liquid separation.

26. The method of claim 23, wherein the separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for

further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products comprises: directing ultrasonic waves having a frequency between 20 Hz and 200 Mhz toward the slurry, wherein the ultrasonic waves aid separation of the slurry into the liquid fraction and the wet fiber.

27. The method of claim 23, wherein the method further comprises: directing germicidal ultraviolet light radiation toward at least one of the slurry, the liquid fraction or the wet fiber, wherein the ultraviolet light is configured to reduce a risk of at least one of bacterial or fungal growth.

28. The method of claim 27, wherein the directing germicidal ultraviolet light radiation toward at least one of the slurry, the liquid fraction or the wet fiber, wherein the ultraviolet light is configured to reduce a risk of at least one of bacterial or fungal growth comprises: directing at least some ultraviolet waves of the ultraviolet light waves that have one or more wave lengths in a range between 100 and 2809 nanometers.

29. The method of claim 23, wherein the method further comprises: creating a negative atmosphere in one or more chambers containing at least some of the slurry to facilitate capture of at least some light volatiles escaping from at least one of the slurry or the extracted liquid fraction; and converting at least some of the captured light volatiles into one or more liquid forms.

30. The method of claim 23, wherein the separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products comprises: separating the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products that include at least one of gluten-free flour, pellets for agricultural feed, fillers for foodstuffs, plastics, adhesives, ethanol, or distilled spirits.

31. The method of claim 23, wherein the separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products comprises: separating the slurry into a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products that include at least one of a pesticide, an insecticide or a fungicide.

32. The method of claim 23, wherein the separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products comprises: separating the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into at least one of liquid, solid, crystal, powdery, granular, or oily products.

33. The method of claim 23, wherein the separating the slurry into (1) a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more first products and (2) a liquid fraction suitable for further processing into one or more second products comprises: separating the slurry into a wet fiber suitable for further processing into one or more materials that can be blended with at least one of an organic material, a dry material, a wet material, or a liquid to produce one or more complex compounds.

34. The method of claim 1, wherein the at least one of an invasive, a poisonous or a toxic plant stock includes at least one of tumbleweed (*salsula targus*), kudzu, rosemary bean (*Abrus precatorius*) or sage brush plant stock.
